

BOYS BASKETBALL

Lutheran West overcomes early woes

Rahula Strohl
The Chronicle-Telegram

ROCKY RIVER — The game reflected the season for Lutheran West.

The Longhorns struggled early in the game, but overcame a 16-point first-quarter deficit to beat MAC-8 rival Columbia, 72-63 on Saturday night.

Likewise, Lutheran West struggled early in the season, going 3-4, but has won six of its past seven games.

"We have new coach, a new way of doing things," said Longhorn senior Josh Ronschke. "We weren't used to it at first, but it's starting to come together, like a puzzle."

Ronschke, who had five rebounds and led the Long-

horns with 16 points, said that he and his teammates were used to setting up a half-court offense. First-year coach Phil Argento prefers to run the court.

Lutheran West (9-5, 7-2) ran all game, and frustrated the Raiders into 22 turnovers, 16 of which came in the second half.

"They were scoring and we weren't (in the first quarter), but our press got us back really quickly in the second quarter, and then it was anybody's game," Argento said. "If we're not going fast, I'm not happy. The speed of the game, I want to dictate it."

Columbia's early sharp shooting didn't allow Lutheran West to grab rebounds and get on the counterattack. The Longhorns committed three turnovers in

MAC-8

the first two minutes.

But late in the first quarter the shots stopped falling, the Longhorns started running, and Columbia managed only 37 points after a 26-point first quarter.

"We came out ready, came out fired up and as the course of the game went along, I don't know, we lost the momentum, lost the fire," said Raider coach Chris Woost. "We couldn't find the bottom of the basket and made stupid choices."

The choice that had Woost scratching his head the most was when senior Ben Magda was called for a technical foul with 5:12 left in the game and the Raiders down by three.

Ruben Davila drained both free throws and the Longhorns scored on the possession afterwards. Magda sat the rest of the game, despite only having four fouls.

"It was a shame, because that was probably the best game of his career," Woost said. "It comes down to him basically putting himself in a situation he knows he shouldn't be in, a situation that hurt us."

"He sat the rest of the quarter, and that was a tough decision because he was having a good game."

Magda finished with 15 points and seven rebounds, going 6-of-6 from the floor. Mike Vyrostek led the Raiders with 23 points and eight rebounds.

At 6-foot-6, he surprised the

Longhorns with a pair of early 3-pointers.

"I have all the kids practice shooting threes, it's part of the game," Woost said. "He (Vyrostek) has a nice touch from outside, so if he's open, he'll take it. He's shooting 44 percent for threes, so I encourage it."

Vyrostek helped keep Columbia in it after Magda sat down, hitting a three that brought the Raiders' deficit to five with just under three minutes to play.

Columbia got the score to 66-63 with 2:30 left to play, but Lutheran West made six defensive stops to end the game.

"At different points of the game I'm looking at different matchups," Argento said. "Especially at the end of the game, I'm looking at who can beat whom and trying to get the ball there."

Ronschke said that Argento's constant re-evaluation was another thing the Longhorns had trouble with.

"He (Argento) changes things all the time, he goes game-to-game, sometimes in the middle of the game," Ronschke said. "We're still not there yet, but these games help."

COLUMBIA (63): Meehan 1-0-3; Gentry 6-3-15; Stefancin 2-1-6; Suintala 0-1-1; Magda 6-3-15; Vyrostek 7-6-23. **Totals 22-14-63.**

LUTHERAN WEST (72): Schiffrik 1-0-2; Ronschke 6-3-15; Wilk 3-1-7; Minnick 5-4-16; Davila 2-6-11; Miller 1-3-3; Semrau 0-4-4; Nemitz 1-0-2; Spurlock 2-5-9. **Totals 21-26-72.**

Columbia 26 13 10 14 — 63
Lutheran West 17 22 17 16 — 72

Three-pointers: Columbia 5-12 (Vyrostek 3-4, Meehan 1-1, Stefancin 1-4, Gentry 0-2, Gerbeck 0-1); Lutheran West 4-10 (Minnick 2-4, Ronschke 1-2, Davila 1-3, Morrison 0-1).

Rebounds: Columbia 28 (Vyrostek 8), Lutheran West 29 (Wilk 9). **Turnovers:** Columbia 22, Lutheran West 23. **Fouled out:** Schiffrik, Technical foul: Magda, 4th, 5:12. **Total fouls:** Columbia 20, Lutheran West 19.

Junior varsity: Lutheran West, 61-54.

Falls rules SWC again

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

NORTH OLMSTED — After a steal and layup by Dave Janis gave North Olmsted a 16-point lead with just 1:21 left in the first half, Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue had seen enough.

Donahue's state-ranked and undefeated Bulldogs were on the ropes for the second straight night Saturday, giving the Falls faithful an uneasy feeling heading into intermission — an eighth straight Southwestern Conference Championship hanging in the balance.

But behind its veteran stalwarts — Steve Gansey and Dan Binggeli — the Bulldogs bounced off the canvas to edge the Eagles, 62-60, to clinch another SWC title. The state's fourth-ranked Division I team improved to 15-0 overall and 11-0 in the league.

Gansey scored 21 points — 13 in the pivotal third quarter — and Binggeli added 14 — six coming in the third. Tim Curran — the football star with a penchant for coming up with big plays — scored 11.

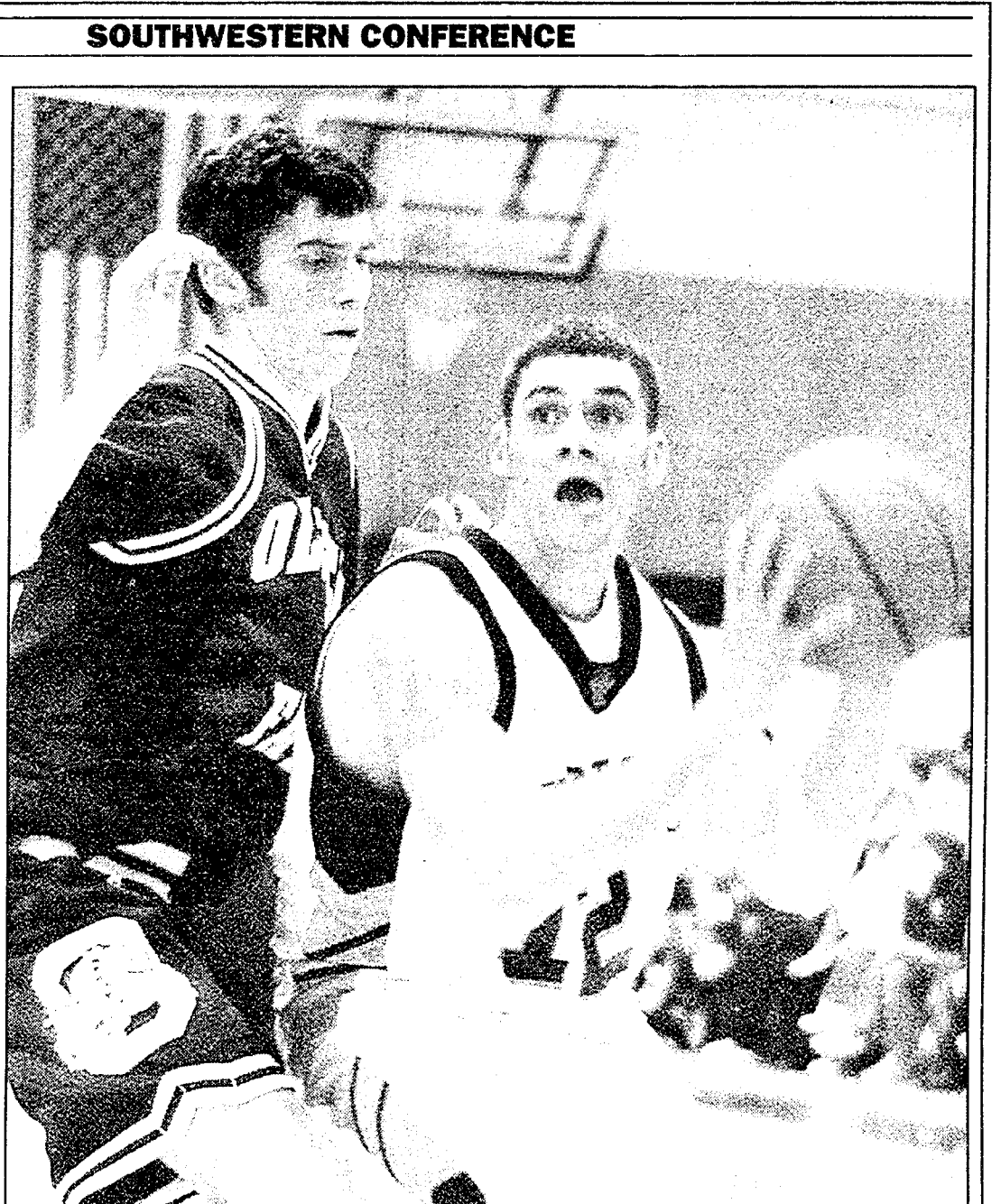
It was Gansey's pair of free throws with 3.6 seconds left in the game that provided the winning margin as Janis missed a 30-foot prayer at the buzzer.

"We were running a set (play) at the end of the game for Steve to get a jump shot," Donahue said. "It didn't flow as smoothly as we would have liked but we eventually got the ball where we wanted it. Steve did a great job taking it to the basket (and getting fouled)."

Janis led the Eagles with 17 points with Mike Easter chipping in 11 off the bench. Tim Connors added 10.

North Olmsted, now 10-6 overall and 7-4 SWC, will have to settle for second place.

"We decided at halftime to pick up our defensive intensity," Donahue said. "We were not doing anything to disrupt their offense. (The Eagles) were doing what they wanted to do."



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

DOGGING AN EAGLE: Olmsted Falls' Eric Arcuri, left, applies defensive pressure to North Olmsted's Mike Easter during the Bulldogs' victory Saturday night.

That's for sure. Coach Tim Schmotzer would have had a hard time drawing up a better first half than the one his team played — except for the final half minute. Falls whittled North Olmsted's 33-17 lead to 35-24 with a neat little five-point run to close out the half and continued the blitz to start the third quarter — catching the Eagles at 38 midway through the period.

"(Falls) had called time out with 1:21 left," Schmotzer said. "Our thing to our kids was let the last 1:21. Well, what happens — we get outscored by five and I thought that gave them some momentum coming in and they carried that momentum over to the third quarter."

"We had to raise the energy level up," said Donahue. "We knew North would be ready to play us. We didn't respond off the bat as well as we'd hoped but hopefully now that the conference is over we can relax a little bit and get ourselves focused on some things

in the future."

Friday Falls climbed out of a 13-point hole to beat Westlake. Saturday, once it caught the Eagles in the third quarter, it should have been clear sailing but to North Olmsted's credit — it never quit.

"We felt we couldn't give them points off turnovers," said Schmotzer. "They really didn't get that the second half. That was a big reason we withstood it when they made that big run at us."

"I felt if we could keep them off the offensive glass it would be a huge key."

The Eagles did a good job boxing out but Falls managed to come up with a couple huge loose balls — one by Binggeli off a Gansey miss — that provided Falls with a 62-60 lead. Connors swished a pair of free throws around a Falls time out with 23.9 left to set up Gansey's heroics.

"They beat us to a key loose ball there at the end of the game," Schmotzer said. "We run that loose ball down —

we're going for the last shot.

"We're proud of what our kids did. We showed great determination and resiliency. It's part of life. If Olmsted Falls is the fourth-ranked team in the state then we should be the fifth team in the state."

Falls, priming itself for its first run at the Midview Division I tournament at the end of the month, is at highly regarded Austintown-Fitch Tuesday.

North Olmsted visits Fairview in SWC play Friday.

OLMSTED FALLS (64) Mickey Mental 1-0-2, Dan Binggeli 6-1-14, Jamar Scales 2-1-5, Tim Curran 3-5-11, Steve Gansey 8-3-21, Corey Sparks 4-0-8, Pat Braddock 1-0-3, Eric Arcuri 0-0-0. **Totals 25-10-63.**

NORTH OLMSTED (62) Dave Janis 6-4-17, Mike Hagen 4-0-9, Steve Trapp 2-0-5, Tim Connors 2-6-10, Matt Rogalski 3-2-8, Chris Hibinger 1-0-2, Mike Easter 5-0-11, Jason Mahon 0-0-0. **Totals 23-12-62.**

Olmsted Falls 13 11 26 14 — 64
North Olmsted 16 19 14 13 — 62

Field goals: Olmsted Falls 25-50 (50 percent), North Olmsted 23-52 (44 percent). **Free Throws:** Olmsted Falls 10-15 (66 percent), Olmsted Falls 12-14 (86 percent).

Rebounds: Olmsted Falls 28 (Sparks 6), North Olmsted 29 (Janis 6). **Turnovers:** Olmsted Falls 13, North Olmsted 13. **Fouls:** Olmsted Falls 12, North Olmsted 16. **Fouled Out:** None.

Three-pointers: Olmsted Falls (4-13) Gansey 2, Braddock, Binggeli, North Olmsted (4-13)

Rockets subdue struggling Shoremen

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

BAY VILLAGE — It was probably not the play on which the outcome of the game hinged, but it hurt nonetheless.

Avon Lake was down by nine points and had the ball after Bay's Matt Phillips missed a pair of free throws with 34 seconds remaining in the first half. A turnover, however, gave the ball back to the Rockets with only a few seconds showing, and a semi-desperation shot by Kyle Lawrence found the range as time ran out to give Bay a lead of a dozen going to halftime.

"We weren't happy at halftime because of one big turnover," Avon Lake coach Dave Olinger said after the Shoremen fell to Bay, 50-37 in a Southwestern Conference game Saturday.

"We had a chance to cut it to seven (points), we turn the ball over and they hit a 3-pointer," Olinger said. "Those kinds of things have happened to us too often this season."

Whether the play would have had any real bearing on the result of the game will never be known. Avon Lake (3-11, 2-9 SWC) did open the second half with two 3-point goals of its own to cut the margin

to six, and ran off 10 unanswered points in the fourth quarter to make the game somewhat interesting down the stretch, but fell too far behind by the end of the third period to make any real headway.

It was the second straight night that Avon Lake had scored only 37 points. The Shoremen lost to Fairview on Friday, 52-37.

"It's frustrating," Olinger said. "We'll just keep plugging away. We'll keep working on things."

The victory raised Bay's record to 9-6 overall and 6-5 in the conference.

"There was nothing spectacular tonight," Bay coach Dave Peters said. "We played good defense when we had to play good defense. Matt Phillips did an excellent job of defending underneath."

Phillips, a 6-foot-8 senior, had seven blocked shots and led the Rockets with 15 points and eight rebounds.

"It was a very mediocre offensive game," Peters said. "We had just enough offense to win. "It was one of those grind-it-out games where our size was a little too much for them and our speed was a little better."

The Rockets hit 20 of 44 field goal attempts (44.4 percent) and only four of 10

foul shots. Bay was ahead by as many as 21 points midway through the fourth quarter, but went 3-43 without scoring and saw the Shoremen score 10 unanswered points to make it an 11-point game with two minutes to play.

Brian Day hit two 3-point baskets to begin the second-half scoring, but Bay responded with nine straight points before Brian Bruce ended the run with a field goal at 1:49 of the third quarter, ending a drought of 4:16 for the Shoremen. The Rockets then went on an 8-0 run for a 43-22 lead, their widest of the evening.

Bruce and Matt Kostelnik led Avon Lake with 10 points each. John Homenik was the game's leading rebounder with 12. The Shoremen were 15-of-49 field goal shooting.

AVON LAKE (37): Brian Day 3-0-8, Jason St. Clair 1-0-2, Matt Kostelnik 4-0-10, John Homenik 2-1-5, Brian Bruce 4-0-10, Justin Resar 1-0-2, Tim Gaydosch 0-0-0, Jacob Gaydosch 0-0-0, David Briggs 0-0-0, Andrew Means 0-0-0, Tony Fox 0-0-0. **Totals 15-1-37.**

BAY (50): Kyle Lawrence 1-1-4, Grant Bodine 2-0-4, Derek Riedel 2-0-5, Tyler Trutza 3-0-9, Matt Phillips 6-3-15, Rob Wenzell 2-0-4, Chris Doyle 2-0-4, Marc Houlas 2-0-5, John Stavlas 0-0-0, Doug VanBuskirk 0-0-0. **Totals 20-4-50.**

Avon Lake 9 5 10 13 — 37
Bay 14 12 17 7 — 50

Three-point goals: Avon Lake 6 (Day 2, Kostelnik 2, Bruce 2), Bay 6 (Trutza 3, Riedel, Lawrence, Houlas). **Rebounds:** Avon Lake 28 (Homenik 12), Bay 23 (Phillips 8). **Turnovers:** Avon Lake 17, Bay 16. **Total fouls:** Avon Lake 14, Bay 10. **Fouled out:** None.

Junior varsity: Bay 53, Avon Lake 43.

Firelands falls to New London

NEW LONDON (15-0) overcame the Falcons' 29-20 halftime lead by outscoring them 33-20 in the second half to win 53-49 Saturday night.

Ron Higgins led Firelands (13-2) with his game-high 19 points, while Jacob Alfiero added 17, including five 3-pointers.

FIRELANDS (49): Born 2-0-4, Schultz 2-3-7, Bant 1-0-2, Alfiero 6-0-17, Higgins 8-3-19. **Totals 19-6-49.**

NEW LONDON (53): Coombs 1-0-2, Evans 2-0-4, Savidge 3-5-13, Welsh 1-3-6, Marshall 5-0-10, Parr 5-4-14, Ferber 2-0-04. **Totals 19-12-53.**

Firelands 14 15 8 12 — 49
New London 9 11 12 21 — 53

Three-pointers: (F) Alfiero 5, (NL) Savidge 2, Welsh.

Junior varsity: Firelands, 48-46.

Lake Erie League

Southview 54, Euclid 47

LORAIN — The Saints outscored Euclid 24-10 in the fourth quarter to win a game that was a make-up of a postponed game on Jan. 24.

Gabe Rios led the Saints (7-8, 3-6 LEL) with 14 points, while Shawn Nixon and Ryan Jackson each added 13.

EUCLID (47): Mimes 6-6-18, Seawright 1-2-4, Dickson 1-0-3, Motley 2-3-7, Stewart 4-6-15. **Totals 14-17-47.**

SOUTHVIEW (54): Nixon 3-5-13, Miller 1-1-3, Brown 2-0-4, Rios 4-4-14, Jackson 3-6-13, Smith 3-1-7. **Totals 17-54.**

Euclid 18 6 13 10 — 47
Southview 13 12 5 24 — 54

Three-pointers: (E) Dickson, Stewart. (S) Nixon 2, Rios 2, Jackson.

Junior varsity: Euclid, 47-40.

Southwestern Conference

Fairview 52, Rocky River 44

FAIRVIEW PARK — The Warriors (7-8, 5-6 SWC) picked up their intensity in the second half after the two teams

ROUNDUP

were tied at halftime.

Fairview's Bub Schuler led all scorers with his 20 points, while Nate Lukasik added 16.

Brian Clark led the Pirates (4-11, 3-8 SWC) with 17 points, while Bryce Sylvester contributed 11.

ROCKY RIVER (44): Sylvester 5-1-11, Clark 6-2-17, Waitkus 2-1-5, Jaeger 1-0-2, Pampush 2-3-7, Schmit 0-2-2. **Totals 16-9-44.**

FAIRVIEW (52): Rozak 1-2-4, Stanton 3-0-8, Eadeh 1-0-2, Davis 0-2-2, Lukasik 7-1-16, Schuler 6-6-20. **Totals 18-11-52.**

Rocky River 4 12 13 15 — 44
Fairview 7 9 17 19 — 52

Three-pointers: (RR) Clark 3, (F) Stanton 2, Lukasik, Schuler 2.

Junior varsity: Fairview, 58-52 (OT).

Non-conference

Admiral King 62, Cleveland South 58

LORAIN — Rob Walton scored a game-high 24 points and pulled down 14 rebounds to lead the Admirals (6-6).

Freshman Danny Hoskins also recorded a double-double, with 13 points and 12 rebounds.

CLEVELAND SOUTH (58): Gaines 6-0-13, McPherson 6-0-14, Forbes 2-0-4, Lee 5-1-12, Patton 2-0-4, Davis 1-0-2, Sharp 3-0-9. **Totals 25-1-58.**

ADMIRAL KING (62): Campbell 3-2-9, Kidd 2-0-5, Hoskins 6-1-13, Milovanovic 2-0-5, Curry 1-2-4, Biber 1-0-2, Walton 11-2-24. **Totals 26-7-62.**

Cleveland South 13 14 15 16 — 58
Admiral King 15 15 14 18 — 62

Three-pointers: (CS) Gaines, McPherson 2, Lee, Sharp 3. (AK) Campbell, Kidd, Milovanovic.

Junior varsity: Admiral King, 49-44.

STATE SCORES

Amherst 65, Westlake 49	Lima Sr. 73, Tol. St. Francis 63
Archbold 59, Haviland Wayne Trace 57	Lorain Admiral King 62, Cle. S. 58
Batavia 68, Day, Stivers 59	Lorain Southview 54, Euclid 47
Bay 50, Avon Lake 37	Loudonville 88, Mansfield Christian 58
Brooklyn 75, Cuyahoga Hts. 51	Loveland 70, Cin. Indian Hill 55
Bucyrus Wynford 59, New Washington Buckeye	Lucas 69, N. Robinson Col. Crawford 61, 2OT
Cent. 52, OT	Mansfield Madison 58, Gallion 49
Can. Heritage Christian 77, Mansfield Temple	Marion Pleasant 66, Cardington Lincoln 44
Christian 56	Metamora Evergreen 78, W. Unity Hilltop 55
Chesapeake 76, Coal Grove Dawson-Bryant 48	Middletown Fenwick 70, Day, Carroll 63
Christian Family 53, Paines 42	Milan Edison 62, Greenwich S. Cent. 44
Cin. Christian 38, Cin. Seven Hills 36	Millersburg W. Holmes 77, Zoarville Tuscarawas
Cin. Country Day 55, Cin. N. College Hill 46	Valley 36
Cin. Harrison 60, Cin. Colerain 45	Millsport 57, Baltimore Liberty Union 41
Cin. Jacobs 71, Portsmouth 69	Montpelier 55, Pioneer North Cent. 43
Cin. Lakota East 69, Springboro 57	Morrat Ridgedale 65, Gallion Northmor 53
Cin. Reading 67, Cin. McNicholas 62	Mt. Blanchard Riverdale 54, Crestline 48
Cin. Summit Country Day 64, Williamsburg 55	New London 53, Oberlin Firelands 49
Cin. Turpin 58, Cin. Mariemont 50	Newark Licking Valley 85, Whitehall Yearling 74
Cin. Western Brown 62, Cin. N. Adams 40	Newton Falls 74, Girard 47
Cle. Benedictine 59, Stow Walsh Jesuit 50	Olmsted Falls 64, N. Olmsted 62
Cle. St. Ignatius 75, Young, Boardman 68, OT	Ontario 65, Bucyrus 59
Cle. VASJ 61, Cle. Glenville 53	Orville 61, Wooster Triway 44
Col. East 78, E. Central 73	Patrick Henry 79, Bloomdale Elmwood 61
Col. Independence 91, Tol. Liberty 79	Pepper Pike University School 55, Cle. East Tech
Coventry 68, Akron North 48	54
Dalton 58, Creston Norwayne 37	Perry 68, Wickliffe 42
Delaware Buckeye Valley 43, Sparta Highland 29	Perrysburg 62, Tol. Bowsher 60, OT
Dover 62, Marietta 57	Philo 72, Grove City 61
E. Cle. Shaw 76, Massillon 64	Pomeroy Meigs 56, Athens 39
Elyria Open Door 55, Cleveland Hts. Lutheran	Port Clinton 59, Shelby 47
East 34	Portsmouth E. 64, Pikelon 63, OT
Fairfield 65, Cin. Northwest 53	Reedsville Eastern 70, Wahama (WVa) 40
Fairview 52, Rocky River 44	Richmond Dale SE 80, McArthur Vinton County
Franklin Furnace Green 55, E. Pike 48	67
Fremont Ross 73, Findlay 69	Rocky River Lutheran W. 72, Columbia 63
Gallipolis Gallia 79, Cheshire River Valley 56	S. Webster 67, Western Latham 45
Gallipolis Gallia Academy 79, Cheshire River Val-	Sandusky 71, Napoleon 64
ley 56	Spring, Cath. Cent. 66, Sidney Lehman Cath. 58
Gates Mills Gilmour 85, Richmond Hts. 72	Spring, Emmanuel Christian 82, Adams County
Greenfield McClain 71, Chillicothe Zane Trace 52	Chris. 47
Heath 63, Sugar Grove Berne Union 50	Spring, Kanton Ridge 39, Kettaring Fairmont 33
Hemlock Miller 66, S. Gallia 58	Spring, Shawnee 57, Spring, Greenon 53
Hillsboro 58, Adena 56	Summit Station Licking Hts. 79, Granville 64
Horizon Science 90, Cleveland Chr. 49	Sylvania Southview 71, Swanton 37
Hudson WRA 65, Canton Cent. Cath. 56	Tiffin Calvert 60, Mansfield St. Peter's 47
Independence 84, Beachwood 76	Tol. Cent. Cath. 71, Tol. Whitmer 38
Jeromesville Hillsdale 46, Apple Creek	Tol. Christian 70, Bettsville 50
Waynedale 39	Tol. Maumee Valley 97, Oregon Stritch 78
Kidron 63, Mogadore Chr. 36	Tol. Ottawa Hills 48, Tol. Emmanuel Baptist 43
Kidron Cent. Christian 63, Mogadore Christian 36	Vincent Warren 61, Ravenswood (WVa) 56
Lakeside Danbury 60, Northwood 47	W. Holmes 77, Tuscarawas Vall. 36
Lexington 55, Vermillion 41	W. Salem NW 74, Rittman 34